



Stephanie Wyatt

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Profile

As the daughter and granddaughter of educators, teaching and learning are primary ways I relate to the world. I am committed to teaching biblical studies within a curriculum that encourages critical inquiry; fosters an empathetic approach towards unfamiliar texts, interpretations, peoples, and cultures; and empowers students to integrate these skills into their personal and vocational narratives. I have found these processes to be transformative in my own life and in the lives of students I have taught and mentored. I believe that theological education should consider the whole person in its efforts at ministerial formation, nurturing the mind, body, and soul of individuals and communities.

Education

Brite Divinity School at Texas Christian University — Ph.D. Candidate

Biblical Interpretation

August 2005–May 2016

Dissertation: *Widows in the Memories of Biblical Israel*

Major Concentration: Hebrew Bible

Minor Concentration: Biblical Theology and Feminist

Hermeneutics

Texas Christian University — Graduate Certificate in Women's Studies
December 2007

Vanderbilt University — M.A. Religion

August 2003–August 2005

Major Concentration: Hebrew Bible

Minor Concentration: Jewish Studies

Wake Forest Divinity School — M.Div

August 1999–May 2002

Omicron Delta Kappa, Service and Leadership Fraternity, 2000

University of Tennessee, Knoxville — B.A. College Scholars, *Summa Cum Laude*

August 1994–May 1998

Specialization: International Justice and French

Phi Beta Kappa—inducted spring of junior year, 1997

Pi Sigma Alpha (American Political Science Association), 1998

- Vernon Iredell International Relations Award

University of Tennessee, Knoxville — Normandy Scholar, Caen France,
Spring 1996

Courses Offered

Middle Tennessee State University — World Religions (one semester)

American Baptists of NY State Lay Studies Program — New Testament (one semester)

American Baptists of NY State Lay Studies Program — Old Testament (one semester)

Brite Divinity School at Texas Christian University — Biblical Hebrew (two semesters)

Texas Christian University — Understanding Religion: Texts and Ideas (TA 6 semesters)

Academic Publications

"Righteous Anger: The Shunammite Woman as a Companion in Grief," in *Bridge Work: Conversations between the Bible and Pastoral Theology*, eds. Denise Dombkowski Hopkins and Michael S. Koppel. Cambridge Scholars Publishing (forthcoming).

"Jezebel, Elijah, and the Widow of Zarephath: A Ménage à Trois Who Estrange the Holy and Make Holy the Strange." *Journal for the Study of the Old Testament* 36, no. 4 (2012): 435–458.

Academic Presentations

"Widow as Icon," Annual Meeting of the National Association of Baptist Professors (NABPR), May 22, 2012.

"Bakhtinian Matchmaking: Odd Couples and Threesomes in 1 Kings 16–19," Society of Biblical Literature Annual Meeting, San Francisco, November 20, 2011.

"Righteous Anger: The Shunammite Woman as a Companion in Grief," National Meeting of the Society of Biblical Literature, Atlanta, November 21, 2010.

"Zion as a Widow Under Siege," Annual Meeting of the National Association of Baptist Professors (NABPR), May 25, 2010.

"The Curious Case of the Biblical Widow," Annual Meeting of the National Association of Baptist Professors (NABPR), May 26, 2009.

"Jezebel, Elijah, and the Widow of Zarephath: A Ménage à Trois Who Estrange the Holy and Make Holy the Strange," Southwest Regional Meeting of the Society of Biblical Literature, March 7, 2009.

Teaching and Work Experience

ASSOCIATE PASTOR, IMMANUEL BAPTIST CHURCH, NASHVILLE, TN, JUNE 2020–PRESENT

My areas of responsibility are education, missions, outreach, and children's ministry. I also preach every six weeks, participate in worship planning, and attend to general needs of the congregation.

INTERIM PASTOR, WEST BAPTIST CHURCH, OSWEGO, NY, SEPT 2017–APRIL 2020

I preached and wrote liturgy for each week's worship, provided pastoral care, joined with the church council in planning church life and activities, led and coordinated Christian education for adults, youth, and children.

INSTRUCTOR, NEW TESTAMENT LAY STUDIES COURSE FOR AMERICAN BAPTISTS OF NY STATE, SPRING 2019

INSTRUCTOR, OLD TESTAMENT LAY STUDIES COURSE FOR AMERICAN BAPTISTS OF NY STATE, SPRING 2018

I designed the course syllabus, gave lectures, supervised student presentations, and facilitated classroom conversation in live and on-line formats.

PROGRAM SPECIALIST, WISE (WOMEN IN SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING) PROGRAM, SYRACUSE UNIVERSITY, OCTOBER 2012–PRESENT.

I coordinate programing for the WiSE Future Professional Program (FPP), which seeks to support women graduate students pursuing careers in STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics) fields.

CO-INSTRUCTOR, INTRODUCTION TO BIBLICAL HEBREW, BRITE DIVINITY SCHOOL AT TEXAS CHRISTIAN UNIVERSITY, AUGUST 2009–MAY 2010.

I taught two semesters of the basics of biblical Hebrew to master level divinity students (M.Div., M.T.S.). I co-taught this class with an international classmate, allowing us both to gain valuable teaching experience and how to construct and carry out a class collaboratively.

INDEPENDENT ENGLISH TUTOR, AUGUST 2008–MAY 2010.

I designed a tutoring program for an international doctoral classmate to strengthen English reading, vocabulary, grammar, and comprehension. We read and discussed news articles, books, and the student's own work.

TEACHING ASSISTANT FOR "RELI 10033 -- UNDERSTANDING RELIGION: TEXTS AND IDEAS" FOR CLAUDIA CAMP, TEXAS CHRISTIAN UNIVERSITY, AUGUST 2007–MAY 2010.

This teaching assistantship involved evaluating daily work for two introductory Hebrew Bible Classes as well as grading two sets of major course essays each semester. Duties also included teaching the class on selected days. The introductory classes consisted of 35–40 students each.

RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO DAVID GUNN, TEXAS CHRISTIAN UNIVERSITY, AUGUST 2006–APRIL 2007.

Gathered research on the topic of reception history and the Davidic narratives for Dr. Gunn's forthcoming commentary on 1–2 Samuel in the Blackwell Series.

PERIODICALS ASSISTANT, VANDERBILT DIVINITY SCHOOL, AUGUST 2003–JUNE 2005.

I cataloged new periodicals into the library's system and processed older issues for binding.

YOUTH MINISTER, GLENDALE BAPTIST CHURCH IN NASHVILLE, TN, MAY 2004–JULY 2005.

Responsibilities included: teaching, curriculum development, and planning social activities for middle and high school students, as well as providing pastoral care to youth and their families. The youth minister leads in worship, encourages youth participation in worship, and preaches periodically.

IMAGINE COLLEGE TUTOR, MCKISSACK MIDDLE SCHOOL, NASHVILLE, TN, AUGUST 2003–MAY 2004.

Imagine College recruits undergraduate and graduate student tutors to work in Nashville's public school system. Tutoring consisted of helping English language learners develop reading skills and understand instructions for completing assignments in various subject areas.

INTERN, BAPTIST JOINT COMMITTEE ON PUBLIC AFFAIRS IN WASHINGTON, DC, FALL 2002–SPRING 2003.

The BJC is an organization that advocates on behalf of religious liberty and separation of church and state from a Baptist perspective. Internship included research, writing, editing, membership education, administration, and curriculum development.

INTERN, WAKE FOREST BAPTIST CHURCH IN WINSTON-SALEM, NC, AUGUST 2000–MAY 2002.

Facilitated educational activities and opportunities for fellowship with youth and college students, worship planning, program administration and facilitation, and pastoral care with all age groups.

SERVANT LEADERSHIP INTERN, VOLUNTEER SERVICES, WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY, AUGUST 1999– MAY 2001.

Administered grant money to student groups for collaborative service projects, advised and supported a student council that coordinated campus-wide service efforts, administered volunteer programs, worked with student leaders and participants, and planned programming.

RESIDENT ASSISTANT FOR SUMMER PROGRAMS, WAKE FOREST UNIVERSITY, SUMMER 2000.

Provided support services for the residential halls housing guests participating in various summer programs across campus. Duties included administering rooming assignments, orienting guests to campus, problem solving, and office work.

ASSOCIATE INTERN, BAPTIST STUDENT UNION AT VIRGINIA TECH, AUGUST 1998–MAY 1999.

Internship included advising student leaders, counseling, programming, and ministry development.

COUNSELOR, TENNESSEE GOVERNOR'S SCHOOL FOR TENNESSEE HERITAGE, SUMMER 1999.

The Governor's School program is an academic enrichment program for high school students who have completed their sophomore or junior year. The job requires assisting in classroom work, living with, and chaperoning the students around the clock for a month's time.

STUDENT ASSISTANT TO DR. JACK REESE, FORMER CHANCELLOR OF UNIVERSITY OF TENNESSEE, KNOXVILLE, AUGUST 1997–JULY 1998.

This job included administrative work and light research for the College Scholars program.

Continuing Education and Organizational Involvement

Nashville West End Clergy Group, Fall 2024–present.

Tennessee Cooperative Baptist Fellowship Pastor's Retreat, 2000–2024.

Tennessee Cooperative Baptist Fellowship General Assembly, Online 2021, 2022, Nashville 2023, Knoxville 2024, and Chattanooga 2025.

Cooperative Baptist Fellowship General Assembly, Atlanta 2023, St. Louis 2025.

Selected Participant, Engaging Children in Worship Cohort, Center for Faith and Children, Trinity Evangelical Seminary, Fall 2024.

Spiritus Jewish-Christian Dialogue Retreat, Penuel Ridge Retreat Center, February 21, 2023.

Selected Participant, BWIM Mentoring Cohort, Fall 2022 – Spring 2024.

Participant, "Excavating Our Roots, Baptist History and the Origins of White Supremacy in the U.S.," Alliance of Baptists Fall Gathering, Montgomery, AL, November 10–12, 2022.

Invited Respondent, Public History Webinar discussing the book, *Doing the Word: Southern Baptists' Carver School of Social Work and its Predecessors, 1907-1997* by T. Laine Scales and Melody Maxwell.

Selected Church Related Publications

"The Blessing of the Womb: A Sermon for Early Advent," in *Sacred Seasons: Creative Worship Tools for Your Church* (Advent/Christmastide 2005): 13–15.

"Each Generation Plays a Role in Preserving Baptist Heritage," *Report from the Capitol*, May 14, 2003.

Selected Presentations

Robert Carr Chapel, Brite Divinity School at Texas Christian University — "Christian Response-ability for 'Never Again,'" A Christian Service for Yom HaShoah: Remembering the Holocaust, January 25, 2011.

Texas Christian University — "This is 'Myspace:' Ending Violence Against Women Through Community," Graduate Student Forum, Women's History Month, February 2007.

Awards and Fellowships

Brite Divinity School at Texas Christian University— Full Tuition Grant and Stipend, 2005–2009.

Vanderbilt University — Susan Ford Wiltshire Essay Prize, graduate level, for "The Shunammite Woman and Elisha: A Feminist Theology of Protest," 2003.

Wake Forest University Divinity School — Wait Fellowship, 1999–2002.

Wake Forest University Divinity School — Ashley and Whitney Walker Scholarship for Excellence in Woman Centered Topics From a Theological Perspective, 2001.

University of Tennessee, Knoxville — J. Wendell Hobby Scholarship, 1996–1998.